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The EN GARDE GAZETTE
THE ELITE FENCERS CLUB WEEKLY

Know yourself, know your enemy, know where you left your glove.

THURSDAY EDITION
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School Fencing Season Starts Nov. 30

Three weapons, 27 bouts, one team score: what Elite FC families should know before New Jersey's 2026–27 high school season.



A high school dual meet at Morris Hills High School, home of the state team finals.

New Jersey high school fencing is a team sport first, which can surprise club families used to fencing for themselves. It also covers all three weapons, so your epeeist will have foil and sabre teammates.

The dual meet. A school team has three squads (sabre, foil and epee), and each sends three starters to the strip. Each starter fences all three opposing starters, so a meet runs 27 bouts, nine per weapon. Bouts go to five touches or three minutes, the length of a pool bout. Each win is one point for the school. The first team to 14 clinches, but all 27 are fenced, and coaches can send in subs.

How it differs. A USA Fencing tournament is individual: pools of five-touch bouts, then a single-elimination bracket of 15-touch bouts. A dual meet has no bracket. Every bout counts the same, so one epee bout can swing a night. Both 2026 state finals ended 14-13.

The calendar. NJSIAA, the state's school sports body, runs the season under NCAA rules. For 2026–27, optional tryouts are Nov. 23–25, first practice is Nov. 30 and meets may start Dec. 7. Teams can fence up to 16 regular-season contests.

The big days. Mid-January brings the Santelli Tournament (girls) and Cetrulo Tournament (boys) at Drew University in Madison. The state's high school coaches association runs both, and USA Fencing calls them the largest and oldest high school team tournaments in the world. Squads place in each weapon, and the lowest combined total wins. They carry prestige but are not state titles. Chatham's girls have won the last four Santellis. Morris County holds its own tournament in late January; in 2026 Chatham's boys won it for a seventh straight year and its girls for a fifth.

The NJSIAA team tournament starts Feb. 9, 2027. The top 16 teams by power points in the North and South brackets qualify, and higher seeds host until the North and South champions meet Feb. 25 at Morris Hills High School. Last winter Bergen Tech won the boys title and Columbia the girls.

Individual states are Feb. 27 at Hunterdon Central. Under last season's rules, the top 36 fencers per weapon in dual-meet rankings on the Touch By Touch app qualify; district qualifiers were dropped in 2025–26. A team or individual state title is the summit.

For club fencers. Last season, state-tournament eligibility required fencing in at least half of a team's meets, a rule NJSIAA says it is revising. NJSIAA also denies petitions from fencers who skip a state championship for a national, regional or other outside event. Check February against your USA Fencing calendar early. Can club epeeists flèche? See sidebar.

Follow along at NJ.com's high school fencing pages and njsiaa.org.

BEN GUTENBERG SYC — ELITE FC

FENCER	FINISH (EPEE)
Mila Siu	3rd, Y12 Women
Penny Young	6th, Y12 Women
Stella Kuo	Top 16, Y14 Women

Super Youth Circuit, Rochester, N.Y., Oct. 2–4. Podium photo, page two.

SEASON AT A GLANCE

WHEN	WHAT (2026–27)
Nov. 23–25	Optional tryouts
Nov. 30	First practice
Dec. 7	Meets may begin
Mid-Jan.	Santelli, Cetrulo (Drew)
Feb. 9–23	State team rounds
Feb. 25	Team finals, Morris Hills
Feb. 27	Individual states

2027 Santelli (girls) and Cetrulo (boys) dates are not out yet; 2026's were Jan. 17–18.

School Rules Let the Flèche Fly

A flèche (French for "arrow") is an aggressive attack in which the fencer's back foot swings past the front one, like an exaggerated stride. For years, New Jersey high schoolers couldn't use it. NJSIAA's 2014–15 fencing guidelines said it flatly: "NO fleching is permitted."

Coaches pushed back. A 2016–17 trial rule let foil and epee fencers cross their feet once per action, and the state coaches association argued it over at its spring and fall 2017 meetings. Safety in cramped gyms was the worry; one coach said a flèche had hit a coach standing beside the strip at a state tournament. By fall the coaches' summary was simple: running attacks out, garden-variety flèche fine.

The limit has since left the books. NJSIAA's 2021–22 rules kept old items like three-minute bouts but listed no flèche restriction. Current rules say NCAA rules govern, and no NJSIAA changes are posted. NCAA uses USA Fencing's rulebook, which allows the flèche in epee and foil but penalizes crashing into an opponent; sabre bans crossing the feet forward at all.

The 2026–27 rules aren't out yet, so check with your coach before you let one fly.

GO CHEER — ELITE FC ENTRIES (ALL EPEE)

OCTOBER NAC · Orlando, Fla. · Fri.–Mon., Oct. 9–12

DAY	EVENT	ELITE FC
Fri 10/9	Cadet Women	Amina Gore, Anayaa Sheth, Penny Young
Fri 10/9	Div. I Men	Maksim Milinkovic
Sat 10/10	Cadet Men	Maksim Milinkovic
Mon 10/12	Y14 Women	Penny Young

MORRIS CUP RYC/RJCC · Suffern, N.Y. · Sat., Oct. 24

TIME	EVENT	ELITE FC
8:00 AM	Junior Women	Amina Gore, Olivia Hayes
8:00 AM	Y12 Men	Kian Jaising, Joshua Jeong, Remy Ng
12:30 PM	Cadet Men	Pablo Aguirre, Connor Anderson, Nico Ng, Caden Wu
3:00 PM	Y14 Women	Stella Kuo, Mila Siu

MEDEO YOUTH CHALLENGE #3 · Bound Brook, N.J. · Sun., Oct. 11

TIME	EVENT	ELITE FC
9:30 AM	Y12 Women	Christina Jiang
11:30 AM	Y10 Mixed	Bryce Cheng

MORRIS CUP RYC/RJCC · Suffern, N.Y. · Sun., Oct. 25

TIME	EVENT	ELITE FC
8:00 AM	Cadet Women	Amina Gore, Adela Sullivan, Penny Young
8:00 AM	Junior Men	Pablo Aguirre, Nico Ng
10:00 AM	Y8 Women	Madeline Siu
10:30 AM	Y12 Women	Christina Jiang, Stella Kuo, Mila Siu
1:30 PM	Y14 Men	Connor Anderson, Noah Gore, Kian Jaising, Remy Ng, Ash Shah-Mirani
3:30 PM	Y10 Men	Bryce Cheng, Joshua Jeong, Rahi Shah Mirani, Maximus Siu

Medeo is this Sunday. Go cheer Christina and Bryce, who are both entered at Morris Cup too. That one is Oct. 24–25 at Rockland Community College's Eugene Levy Field House, with 20 Elite FC fencers and 29 entries as of Wednesday. Not on the list? Check the tournament page for entry deadlines.

WEEKLY CLASSES AT ELITE FC

DAY	TIME	CLASS
Mon	4:30–6:00 PM	Little Musketeers
Tue	6:00–7:30 PM	Group class
Wed	5:00–6:30 PM	Little Musketeers
Wed	6:30–7:15 PM	Footwork class
Thu	6:00–7:30 PM	Group class
Fri	4:15 PM	Mini Musketeers (ages 5–7)
Fri	6:00–10:00 PM	Open bouting
Sat	11:00 AM–12:30 PM	Little Musketeers
Sat	1:00–2:30 PM	Group class
Sun	—	Closed

Mini Musketeers now starts at 4:15 on Fridays. Private lessons fill other open hours. Source: club website; check with the club for the latest.

NAC Opens National Season in Orlando

USA Fencing's first national tournament of 2026–27, the October North American Cup, runs Friday through Monday, Oct. 9–12, at the Orange County Convention Center in Orlando, Fla., USA Fencing's first visit there since 2023. It gives fencers an early shot at national ranking points. Admission is free. Epee runs all four days (see box). The fields are deep: as of Wednesday, more than 380 fencers had registered for Division I men's epee, 200 for Cadet women's epee and 172 for Y14 men's epee, according to FencingTracker. Live results will post at usafencing.org/2026-october-nac.

NAC EPEE BY DAY

DAY	EPEE EVENTS
Fri 10/9	Div. I Men · Cadet Women · Para Men and Women
Sat 10/10	Cadet Men · Cadet Women's Team
Sun 10/11	Div. I Women · Cadet Men's Team
Mon 10/12	Y14 Men · Y14 Women



Elite FC's Mila Siu and Penny Young pose with other medalists at the Ben Gutenberg SYC awards in Rochester. Mila finished 3rd and Penny 6th in Y12 women's epee. Results on page one.

PARENT Q&A

Q. ***Does the new points system affect my kid's Youth events?***

A. No. USA Fencing's trial points system, which started Aug. 1, covers Cadet, Junior and Division I (Senior) events only. Youth events stay on the existing points tables; the trial does not touch them.

Song Rallies to Asian Games Gold

South Korea's Song Se-ra won women's epee gold at the Asian Games in Japan on Sept. 22. She won her quarterfinal and semifinal 15-14 each; against Japan's Tamaki Terayama in the semis, she trailed 14-13 and scored the last two. Song, 33, is a two-time world champion but had never won an individual Asian Games or Olympic title. Down 14-13 is not done.

World Cup Epee Heads to Casablanca

The senior epee World Cup stops in Casablanca, Morocco, Oct. 15–18, with 579 athletes from 68 nations entered, per the FIE. Results: fie.org.

Club Parent Builds Fencing Journal App

Elite FC parent Eric Anderson has released Remise, a free fencing journal app on Apple's App Store (iOS 17 or later). Fencers can log bouts, lessons and notes on opponents while they're fresh, and import results from FencingTracker so head-to-head history stays in one place. There's no account to make and no ads. Search "Remise Fencing Journal" on the App Store. Anderson says he welcomes feedback.